

LISTENING

#06

1 – Listen to a political candidate giving a campaign speech. Pay attention to what promises the speaker makes, what changes they propose, and how they plan to improve education, the city center, and public transportation.

Campaign Election

1 - What kind of event is the speaker participating in?

- a) a political campaign speech
- b) a school assembly
- c) a business meeting

2 - What is the first main issue the speaker discusses?

- a) improving public education
- b) lowering property taxes
- c) building more highways

3 - How does the speaker plan to fund improvements to public schools?

- a) by increasing taxes
- b) by rechanneling existing tax revenue
- c) by taking out government loans

4 - What does the speaker say about the current government's progress in education?

- a) they have made a lot of progress
- b) they have ignored education issues
- c) they have talked about it but done little

5 - What is the second issue the speaker discusses?

- a) city center development
- b) airport expansion
- c) healthcare access

6 - What new project does the speaker propose for the city center?

- a) a shopping mall
- b) a revitalization project with new businesses and green spaces
- c) a new sports arena

7 - What long-term project does the speaker propose for transportation?

- a) a new light rail system
- b) a city bus route
- c) a bicycle rental program

8 - What reason does the opponent give against voting for the speaker?

- a) lack of experience
- b) dishonesty
- c) too many promises

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

Infrastructure Education Economy

Modern societies depend on two pillars that shape both economic success and social progress: education and infrastructure. These areas may seem different, but in reality, they are closely connected and mutually supportive. A well-educated population needs reliable transport and digital systems to put their knowledge into practice, while good infrastructure allows education to reach everyone, from large cities to rural communities.

Investment in education is not just about constructing new schools. It also means attracting and keeping qualified teachers, updating learning materials, and ensuring students develop the skills required in a changing world. In countries that continually improve their education systems—such as Finland, Singapore, or Canada—there is a clear link between school quality and national innovation. Students from these systems grow into professionals who strengthen the economy through creativity and efficiency.

However, education alone cannot drive growth if people and goods cannot move easily. Efficient transportation—roads, rail networks, and public transit—connects workers with jobs, companies with markets, and families with services. When infrastructure is neglected, cities lose productivity, rural areas become isolated, and social inequality increases. In contrast, modern public transport and digital infrastructure encourage sustainable development and reduce pollution.

The challenge for policymakers is to balance short-term costs with long-term benefits. Building new rail lines or renovating schools requires large investments, but the return is measured in stronger economies, lower unemployment, and a more skilled workforce. Economists argue that each dollar spent on infrastructure and education eventually multiplies its value through higher productivity and better living standards.

In the end, a nation's strength is not only built on natural resources or technology, but on its people and the systems that support them. Investing in minds and movement—education and infrastructure—is one of the smartest, most future-oriented decisions any government can make.

Retrieved from: <https://www.washingtonpost.com/opinions/2024/07/10/infrastructure-education-economy/>

Comprehension Questions

1. What two areas are described as the main pillars of modern societies?

2. Why is investment in education more than just building new schools?

3. What happens when infrastructure is neglected?

4. Do you agree that education and infrastructure depend on each other? Why or why not?

5. If you were a leader, which area would you fund first—education or transportation? Explain.
